STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION PHASE

1. Introduction

The Brainstorming and Ideation phase is the first phase of the project. In this phase, the project idea, problem area, proposed solution, objectives and expected benefits are identified.

The selected project focuses on streamlining the IT procurement process by automating Standard Laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

2. Problem Identification

In the IT procurement process, standard laptop requests may involve manual activities such as task creation and task assignment.

These manual activities can cause:

- Delays in laptop configuration
- Additional manual workload
- Waiting time in the procurement process
- Possible errors in task assignment
- Inefficient utilisation of resources

Therefore, an automated solution is required to streamline the Standard Laptop procurement process.

3. Project Idea

The proposed idea is to use **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to automate the Standard Laptop procurement workflow.

When a Standard Laptop request is approved, the system should automatically create a Catalog Task and assign it to the **Hardware** group for laptop configuration.

4. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution consists of:

1. Creating a Flow in ServiceNow Flow Designer.
2. Using a Service Catalog trigger.
3. Creating a Catalog Task automatically.
4. Configuring the required task details.
5. Assigning the task to the Hardware group.
6. Connecting the Flow with the Standard Laptop catalog item.
7. Testing the complete procurement workflow.

5. Project Objectives

The main objectives of the project are:

- To automate the Standard Laptop procurement process.
- To reduce manual intervention.
- To automatically create Catalog Tasks.
- To assign tasks to the Hardware team.
- To reduce waiting time.
- To reduce possible errors and delays.
- To improve task allocation.
- To improve resource utilisation.
- To improve overall procurement efficiency and productivity.

6. Expected Benefits

The proposed automation is expected to provide the following benefits:

- Faster task generation
- Reduced manual workload
- Better task allocation
- Reduced waiting time
- Improved resource utilisation
- Improved procurement efficiency
- Improved productivity
- Reduced possibility of manual errors

7. Proposed Workflow

The initial project idea is represented through the following workflow:

Standard Laptop Request

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Request Approval

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Flow Designer Trigger

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Create Catalog Task

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Assign to Hardware Group

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Laptop Configuration

8. Technology Identified

The project will be developed using:

Platform: ServiceNow

Main Tool: Flow Designer

Service: Service Catalog

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop

Task Assignment Group: Hardware

9. Expected Outcome

The expected outcome of the project is an automated Standard Laptop procurement workflow in ServiceNow.

After the required request and approval process, the system should automatically generate a Catalog Task and assign it to the Hardware group for laptop configuration.

10. Conclusion

The brainstorming and ideation phase identifies the need for automation in the Standard Laptop procurement process.

The proposed ServiceNow Flow Designer solution aims to reduce manual intervention, improve task allocation and streamline the overall IT procurement workflow.

This project idea forms the foundation for the subsequent requirement analysis, design, planning, development, testing, documentation and demonstration phases.